one side surrenders. A central feature of a conventional war is the conquest of territories. In a war in which a conventional army—the IDF—is facing guerrilla forces, the results are measured by the extent of the physical elimination of the guerrilla fighters and the destruction of their assets—weapons, equipment, and infrastructure.

According to this test:

- The IDF killed about a thousand Hezbollah fighters, which constituted about a third of their regular fighting force.
- We destroyed all the long-range missiles on their launchers, even before they were launched—this says something about the quality of the intelligence we had.
- We eliminated the majority of Hezbollah's medium-range missiles and launchers. Each launcher was destroyed immediately after its first launch, because of its creation of an electronic signature that enabled us to home in on it. This says something about our operational capabilities.
- We destroyed a large portion of their infrastructure (bunkers, headquarters, offices, outposts, trenches, and more).

If the objective of the war were to destroy and subjugate Hezbollah, we would have had to activate a much larger ground force than we did, occupy and hold territory, and do all of this in a week to ten days, because Israel—in the eyes of the world—does not have the luxury of long wars.

What did we not achieve in this war? We did not succeed in silencing the short-range rockets in the Galilee, which do not carry an electronic signature. We also did not bring Hezbollah to the point of raising a white flag. In this regard, one must remember what was pointed out at the beginning of this chapter—that according to Muslim belief, a victory that is not unmistakable is a defeat for the enemy and a victory for the Muslim.

There were many failures in this war, which we must investigate, draw lessons from, and correct. The media coverage blew these failures completely out of proportion, creating the image of disaster.

There were, however, some other achievements of this war, including the following: